

“An Investigation into Teachers’ Feedback Practices in Secondary Level English Language Classrooms”

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MIRZA MONIR

Roll No. 25-648

Academic Year: 2024–2025

Department of Language Education

Institute of Education and Research

University of Dhaka

Research Supervisor:

Tasmia Nawrin

Associate Professor,

IER, University of Dhaka

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SUBMITTED BY MIRZA MONIR, STUDENT OF M.ED , INSTITUTE OF EDUCATION AND RESEARCH , UNIVERSITY OF DHAKA

Research Supervisor

Tasmia Nawrin

Head, Department of Language Education,
IER, University of Dhaka

Hosne Ara Begum

Director

Institute of Education and Research
University of Dhaka

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CHAPTER ONE: 1. INTRODUCTION

Learning of the English language is a vital component of secondary education as it helps learners to acquire communicative competence, expand their academic knowledge and engage in wider domains of education and professional contexts. In the process of learning a language, learners need opportunities to develop the different language skills and receive appropriate responses to their performance. Just doing class activities and getting grades cannot be enough for language development. Also, learners need to know what they did right and wrong and how they can improve their performance. Therefore, the teacher's feedback plays an important role in teaching and learning languages.

Feedback, in general, is information that is given to learners about their performance with the purpose of helping them with further learning and improvement. In an English language classroom, feedback can take various forms. Teachers may provide feedback to students by correcting their grammatical mistakes, reformulating their utterances, commenting on their writing, asking them to self-correct, praising appropriate language use or giving suggestions for improvement. The feedback can also differ according to the timing and approach. For instance, teachers may provide immediate feedback during the classroom interaction or delayed feedback after an activity has been completed. Similarly, feedback may be given individually or to the whole class. Therefore, the feedback is not a single classroom technique; it includes various practices through which teachers respond and support learners' language learning.

Teacher's feedback is particularly important in second or foreign language classrooms because language learners need guidance regarding the accuracy, appropriateness and effectiveness of their language use. When students make errors, teachers can use different feedback strategies depending on the nature of the error, learning objective, students' proficiency levels and classroom situation. For instance, the teacher can directly provide the correct form, give a clue so that the learner can self-correct, reformulate the learner's utterance or explain the linguistic rule. The different approaches may provide different opportunities for the students to notice their errors and participate actively in the learning process. Therefore, understanding the teachers' feedback practices is important for understanding how classroom interaction is contributing to language learning.

Feedback can also play a role beyond just error correction. In a learner-centred classroom, feedback may encourage students to reflect on their own performance, identify areas for improvement and become more responsible for their learning. Formative feedback, in particular, can provide information that helps the learners understand their current level of performance and guide them toward future improvement. Thus, effective feedback can be considered as part of the learning process, not just a way to identify the students' mistakes. However, the educational value of feedback depends on how teachers use it, how students respond to it and whether classroom conditions allow teachers to provide meaningful and timely feedback.

In Bangladesh, English is an important subject at the secondary level and the English language classrooms generally involve students with different levels of proficiency, learning needs and classroom participation. Within this context, teachers have to manage the language teaching along with various practical classroom demands. Large classes, limited instructional time, examination-oriented practices, differences in the students' proficiency and teachers' professional preparation may influence how feedback is provided. Thus, in this context, the teachers' feedback practices need to be understood within the realities of the Bangladeshi secondary English classrooms rather than just from a theoretical perspective.

The previous studies in Bangladesh have provided useful evidence about the assessment and feedback practices in English language classrooms. For instance, Rahman, Babu, and Ashrafuzzaman (2011) examined assessment and feedback practices and found that teachers relied considerably on closed-ended questions and textbook-based activities. Their study also indicated that speaking and listening received comparatively less attention and feedback was not always provided regularly. Although the teachers recognized the importance of feedback, classroom observations indicated that much of the feedback was oral and focused on correcting students' answers. These findings suggested that there may be differences between teachers' understanding of the importance of feedback and the way feedback has been implemented in classroom practice.

A more focused research has also examined corrective feedback in the Bangladeshi secondary context. For instance, Tasnuva (2019) investigated oral corrective feedback in junior secondary-level English classrooms and found that teachers commonly used explicit correction and recasts when responding to students' language errors. The metalinguistic feedback was used less frequently. The study also found that delayed corrective feedback was commonly used, suggesting that the teachers allowed the students to complete their utterances before addressing their errors. This study is important because it shows that the feedback practices involve not only the type of correction teachers use but also the timing of feedback and how the teachers manage classroom interaction.

Recent research has further expanded the discussion by examining the written corrective feedback and formative assessment. For instance, Rahman (2025) explored written corrective feedback in secondary English writing classes and found that teachers used both direct and indirect feedback, although the use of different feedback types was not consistent. The study also highlighted the students' preference for indirect feedback because it allowed them opportunities to identify and correct their own mistakes. At the same time, the teachers reported practical challenges such as limited time, large class sizes and differences in students' English proficiency. These findings indicate that the teachers' feedback practices are influenced not only by pedagogical choices but also by the conditions in which teaching is taking place.

Similarly, Rana and Rana (2025) examined formative assessment and feedback practices among secondary English teachers. Their findings showed that the teachers used continuous feedback and frequent assessment to support students' learning. However, limited training in formative

assessment was identified as a challenge. Thus, the teachers' professional knowledge and training may also influence their capacity to use feedback effectively. Together, the studies indicate that feedback is an important but complex aspect of the English language teaching in Bangladeshi secondary classrooms.

Although the previous studies have provided valuable insights, the existing literature is somewhat fragmented. Some studies have been focused mainly on oral corrective feedback while others have concentrated on written corrective feedback or formative assessment. Therefore, there is a need to have a broader understanding of teachers' feedback practices across different classroom situations. In particular, it is important to examine what types of feedback teachers use, how they provide feedback during classroom interaction and what challenges they face while providing feedback. Furthermore, there is a need to examine the teachers' reported practices alongside their actual classroom practices. Classroom observation can provide evidence of what teachers actually do, while the interviews can provide insight into teachers' explanations and experiences.

Therefore, the present study focuses on the teachers' feedback practices in secondary English language classrooms in Bangladesh. The study adopts a qualitative approach to develop an in-depth understanding of the feedback practices from both the observed classroom interactions and the teachers' perspectives. It will examine the types of feedback used by the secondary English teachers, the ways in which feedback is provided and the challenges the teachers face in providing effective feedback.

The study will be guided by three research questions:

1. What types of feedback do secondary English teachers use in their classrooms?
2. How do secondary English teachers provide feedback to their students?
3. What challenges do teachers face in providing effective feedback?

By exploring these questions, the study aims to provide a contextual understanding of the teacher feedback practices in secondary English language classrooms. The findings may contribute to a better understanding of the current classroom feedback practices and may provide useful insights for English language teachers, teacher educators and researchers interested in language teaching and assessment in Bangladesh.

CHAPTER TWO: LITERATURE REVIEW

Feedback plays a role in English language teaching. Feedback allows learners to see what they do well spot mistakes and grow their language skills. In a classroom teachers can give feedback in ways: through spoken comments, written corrections, direct corrections, recasts, metalinguistic remarks and formative guidance.. The power of feedback is not only in the kind of feedback but also in how often it is given, when it is delivered and why it is delivered. In Bangladeshi English language classrooms many studies have looked at assessment and feedback especially corrective and formative kinds. Those studies give information about teachers' current habits, what students like and the problems teachers face.

Rahman, Babu and Ashrafuzzaman (2011) looked at assessment and feedback in Bangladeshi English classrooms. Their results show that assessments mostly used closed-ended questions and textbook tasks. Speaking and listening did not get focus and students rarely had chances to do creative or higher-order language work. Even though teachers said feedback matters classroom notes show that feedback was not given often. When feedback occurred it was mostly. Aimed at fixing students' answers. These results matter because they point to a gap between teachers' ideas about feedback and how they actually act. In words teachers think feedback is vital but many classroom and teaching factors affect how often and how well they give feedback. The study therefore says that feedback in Bangladeshi English classrooms must become frequent more useful and more learner-centered. For the research this study offers a useful background for the broad picture of assessment and feedback in Bangladesh. Still because the study happened than ten years ago it might not reflect today's secondary English classrooms. Also the study looked at assessment and feedback in a sense not just at teachers' feedback habits as the main focus.

Tasnuva (2019) focused tightly on oral corrective feedback in Bangladeshi secondary schools. The research involved six teachers and 174 students from three Bengali-medium schools in Dhaka looking at both the kinds of feedback and the timing of feedback. The results show that teachers mainly used correction and recasts while metalinguistic feedback appeared less often. The study also found that teachers liked to give delayed feedback meaning they corrected errors after students finished speaking than immediately. This is important because the timing of feedback can shape classroom talk. Immediate correction can break a student's flow while delayed feedback lets students finish their ideas before errors are pointed out. The study also reported that the good effects of feedback outweighed the bad effects on students. Thus Tasnuva's work shows that feedback is not about whether teachers fix mistakes; the type and timing of correction are key parts of teachers' feedback habits.

However Tasnuva's (2019) research looked at oral corrective feedback. Because of this we get a view of the many ways teachers can give feedback in secondary English classrooms. For instance teachers can comment on grammar, pronunciation, vocabulary, writing, participation,

understanding or how well a task was done. That feedback can be. Written, given to one student or to the whole class and it can come right away or after a delay. Therefore there is still room to study teachers' feedback habits from a classroom angle instead of focusing solely on oral correction.

Recent research has shifted the focus to written corrective feedback. Rahman (2025) studied written feedback in English writing classes in Bangladesh looking at what kinds of written feedback teachers used what students liked and what problems teachers faced. The study used a mix of methods with teachers and students from two government schools. The findings show that teachers often used written feedback but the way they used it varied across parts of students' writing. Teachers mainly gave indirect feedback while metalinguistic and coded feedback appeared less often. A key finding was that students preferred feedback because it let them spot and fix their own mistakes.

This result adds a twist to the feedback conversation. Feedback works better when students can think about it not when teachers hand out the right answer. The study therefore says that teachers' feedback habits must be seen through what students think and like. The study also found real-world obstacles: not time, big classes and students who vary in English skill. These problems can limit how detailed and personal a teacher can make feedback. So Rahman's (2025) work shows that teachers' feedback habits depend not on what teachers choose to do but also on the classroom reality.

The study matters for today's research because it shows a gap between feedback ideas and real classroom life. Teachers know that personal and useful feedback matters, but big classes, short lessons and mixed English skill levels can make that hard.. The study looks only at written feedback in writing lessons. So it does not show how secondary English teachers use feedback in all kinds of activities and learning contexts. That gap gives the study a chance to look at feedback habits more fully.

Rana and Rana (2025) added to the literature by studying assessment and feedback in secondary English classrooms. They used a qualitative case study gathering stories from interviews and watching classes. They found that teachers gave feedback and ran regular language checks to help students learn. The study also noted that teachers' desire to try teaching ways was a key driver of feedback habits. Still the study pointed out that teachers had not enough training in assessment, which was a big obstacle.

This study moves the conversation from seeing feedback as fixing mistakes to seeing it as part of learning. Ongoing feedback and formative checks let teachers spot where students struggle and change teaching to help. So feedback can serve not as a reaction to errors but also as a way to watch and aid learning. The finding that teachers have training shows that teachers' feedback habits depend on what they know and how they are prepared. This matters, in Bangladeshi secondary schools, where teachers must deal with school rules and classroom limits while trying to use learner-centered assessment.

Research Gap

Based on the reviewed literature, some research gaps can be identified.

1. There is a lack of a broader investigation of teachers' feedback practices

In the reviewed literature, most of the studies were focused on investigating particular types of teachers' feedback practices, such as oral corrective feedback (Tasnuva, 2019), written corrective feedback (Rahman, 2025), or specific form of assessment, such as formative assessment (Rana & Rana, 2025). In contrast, less attention is paid to investigating various feedback practices used in secondary EFL classrooms. Thus, the current study can make a contribution by exploring different types of feedback practices used by the teachers in one study.

2. There is a limited focus on teachers' actual practices;

While previous research identified what types of feedback were used by the teachers, there is a need to explore how the teachers actually give feedback during classroom interaction. Thus, an empirical study can be conducted to identify teachers' feedback practices through teacher interviews and classroom observations.

3. There is limited information about why teachers give certain types of feedback;

While previous studies identified what types of feedback were used by the teachers to address learners' errors, there is a need to elicit teachers' rationale behind their feedback practices. Thus, the next step in the research would be to conduct a qualitative study to identify the reason why teachers give explicit correction/recasts, direct/indirect feedback, or any other type of feedback. Teachers can give certain types of feedback based on the level of their learners, the amount of time they have in classes, the objectives of their classes, the type of their learners' errors, and their personal beliefs regarding language learning.

4. There is a lack of research on whether teachers' beliefs about feedback correlate with their practices

In the study conducted by Rahman et al. (2011), it was found that teachers who recognized the importance of providing any feedback to their learners did not always reflect this awareness in their classroom practices. Thus, in order to see if teachers' beliefs about feedback influence their feedback practices, there is a need to conduct another empirical study.

5. There is a need to update the information about teachers' feedback practices in the context of secondary-school;

Most of the previous studies were conducted several years ago, while the last ones explored only particular types of feedback (written/oral). Thus, the study can be conducted to update the evidence about teachers' feedback practices in secondary-school settings.

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CHAPTER THREE :RESEARCH METHODOLOGY

3.1 Research Approach and Design

This study is qualitative in nature and has qualitative descriptive research design to investigate teachers' feedback practices in English language classrooms at secondary level in Bangladesh. Because the aim of this study is to obtain an in-depth knowledge of the way teachers give feedback, what kind of feedback they use, and the problems they might encounter in providing feedback to their students, a qualitative approach is appropriate. This research does not rely on numerical data to measure the frequency and/or effectiveness of feedback; instead, it aims to gain insight into the practices and experiences of teachers within the context of their actual classrooms.

The study focuses particularly on the actual classroom practices of secondary English teachers as well as their perspectives and experiences. Classroom observation will be used to look at the types of feedback given in actual English lessons, and semi-structured interviews will enable the teachers to elaborate on their practices, decision making and problems. So the union of these two sources of qualitative data will give a broader understanding of teachers' feedback practices.

The study is guided by the following three research questions: (1) What types of feedback do secondary English teachers use in their classrooms? The following research questions came to mind: (2) How do secondary English teachers give feedback to their students? and (3) What challenges do teachers encounter in providing effective feedback?

3.2 Research Setting

The study will take place in Secondary level English language classroom in Bangladesh. The natural context will be the classroom to observe the teachers' feedback practices in regular English lessons. Special emphasis will be placed on various contexts in which teachers give students feedback, such as speaking, writing, grammatical, lexical, pronunciation, comprehension and other language learning activities.

For this study, the classroom environment is crucial because the feedback that is given may differ depending on the nature of the lesson, students' answers, classroom interaction, and the immediate teaching context. This approach of observing teachers in their regular lessons will therefore help the researcher to better understand how feedback is being provided in practice, and not just through teachers' descriptions of classroom practice.

3.3 Participants and Sampling

The subjects of the study will be 5-7 secondary school English teachers. Participants will be purposefully selected for the study as it demands teachers with relevant experience teaching English at the secondary school level and with a capacity to give valid information on their feedback practices.

To be included in the study, the participants will be currently teaching English at the secondary level, have experience of providing feedback to English language learners, and be willing to participate in the semi-structured interview. They will also have to grant permission for the researcher to observe their teaching in the classroom. The selection of the participants will be guided by these criteria and will guarantee that the collected data will be relevant to the research questions.

Participants' numbers are deemed adequate for a qualitative study as the objective of the research is not to produce statistically generalizable data. Rather, the aim of this study is to gain detailed and context-specific information on teachers' feedback practices, experiences, and challenges.

3.4 Data Collection Instruments

The data collecting tools used in this study are two kinds, including classroom observation checklist and semi-structured interview guide. Both instruments will be designed according to the research questions and will complement each other and give information from both the classroom practice and the teachers' side.

3.4.1 Classroom Observation

Teachers' feedback in the regular English lessons will be looked at using a classroom observation checklist. The observation will primarily focus on the first and second research questions, focusing on the variety of feedback teachers offer and how they give students feedback.

Attention will be paid to the various types of feedback provided, such as oral and written feedback, corrective and positive feedback, explicit correction, recasts, elicitation, self-correction and metalinguistic feedback during the observation. The researcher will also take note of when the feedback was given, if it was given at once or later. Furthermore, whether feedback is given to the entire class or to the individual student, as well as which aspects of language are being feedback on, e.g. grammar, vocabulary, pronunciation or writing.

The researcher will also keep brief field notes for important classroom events and examples of feedback given, as well as for some of the interesting interactions between teacher and student, with the observation checklist. These observations and field notes will enable the researcher to note the teachers' real feedback practises and contrast these with the feedback practises reported in the interviews.

3.4.2 Semi-Structured Teacher Interview

Participating teachers will complete a semi-structured interview to gain insight into their views, experiences, and explanations on feedback practices. The interview questions will be directly related to the following three research questions:

The two research questions will be addressed in a variety of ways using questions. Questions will be used in a variety of ways to address the two research questions, one of which addresses the different types of feedback teachers use and the other addresses their response to students' errors. Responses to the second research question will address such issues as who, when and how teachers give feedback to students, and what they cite as pedagogic strategies to promote student response to and engagement with the feedback. Lastly, questions concerning the third research question will focus on the difficulties teachers have in giving feedback, such as class sizes, time constraints for instruction, differences in student proficiency, pressure of exams, and a lack of professional training.

It will be a semi-structured format with a list of questions to be used by the researcher and also some follow-up questions to ask if the participants give important and unexpected information. This will allow the researcher to gain a detailed picture of teachers' experiences and views. The alignment of the research questions with the data collection tools is of an acceptable level. The ability of aligning research questions with data collection tools is acceptable.

The instrument used for data collection will be closely related to the research questions. Generally, the types of feedback used by teachers and the provision of feedback during classroom interaction will be the main area of focus in the classroom observation. The semi-structured interviews will be used alongside the observations to gain teachers' explanations of their practice and problems that they face to carry it out.

This will enable the researcher to answer each research question using relevant sources of data. Classroom observations will give evidence of what teachers do in lessons, and interviews will give information about their perspectives, reasons and experiences. The combination of both sources will also enable the researcher to make a comparison between the reported practices and what is happening during the real classroom.

3.6 Data Collection Procedure

Data collection will take place in a number of stages. The researcher will gain permission from the school authorities relevant to this research before data collection begins. The teachers who participate in the study will also be given clear information about the purpose of the study, their role in the study and the confidentiality of information they share, and they will give informed consent.

Classroom observations will take place in the regular English classes after permission and consent is obtained. The researcher will observe teachers' feedback using the observation checklist and field notes on the relevant classroom events will be recorded. The researcher will be as unobtrusive as possible during the observations in order to not needlessly interfere with the natural pattern of classroom interaction.

After classroom observations, semi-structured interviews with the teachers involved will take place. The interviews will provide an opportunity to discuss their feedback practices, how they give feedback and their struggles. If the subjects are willing, the interviews will be taped to provide accurate transcription of the subjects' responses. Finally, recorded interviews are transcribed and classroom observation notes and interview transcriptions will be sorted for further analysis.

3.7 Data Analysis

Data analysis will be conducted with thematic analysis method, which was based on data obtained from classroom observations and semi-structured interviews. This approach is suitable as the purpose of the study is to look for recurring patterns, ideas and themes in teachers' feedback practices and experiences.

The analysis process will start with a re-reading of the interview transcripts and the notes of classroom observations made by the researcher to familiarize him/her with the data obtained. Once familiar with the data, meaningful portions of the transcripts and observation notes will be given initial codes. Such codes will stand for key concepts and/or practices identified in the data. Similar or related codes will then be grouped together to develop broader themes.

Themes will be discussed and adjusted to capture the data collected. Last, the themes identified will be explained with regard to the three research questions and contrasted with the results of other studies which were mentioned in the literature review. For instance, codes such as correction, recast, elicitation and praise can be included in a larger picture of the nature of feedback provided by teachers. Likewise, codes relating to large classes size, limited time, and student differences in proficiency may help to identify a theme around the difficulty that may be experienced in providing feedback.

These examples will not be considered "facts found," however. Final themes will be developed from the real data gathered throughout the study. The researcher will then compare information gained from classroom observation and interview questions to determine if teachers' reported practices are similar to what is observed in their classrooms.

3.8 Trustworthiness of the study.

A number of strategies will be employed to increase the credibility of the study. Firstly, data triangulation will be employed by collecting data based on classroom observation and semi-structured interviews. The two sources would enable the researcher to make a comparative analysis between teachers' reported feedback practices and their actual behaviors in the classroom, thereby gaining a holistic understanding of the phenomenon.

Second, the use of "member checking" is possible when it is needed. The researcher could provide an opportunity for the participating teachers to discuss with him or her the interpretation of the teacher's responses in the interview and to check for any misinterpretation. This will ensure that the participants' opinions are expressed correctly.

Finally, the researcher will keep field notes and a reflective journal all through the research process. These records will assist the researcher in thinking through how to collect data and how to analyze it and to keep in mind what personal assumptions might affect their analysis. These strategies will contribute to the credibility and trustworthiness of the findings, when used together.